

ShopEase — Customer Refund Policy

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1. Refund Eligibility & Triggers

At ShopEase, customer satisfaction and prompt financial settlement are core operational commitments. Refunds are automatically triggered under the following verifiable conditions:

- **Pre-Shipment Order Cancellation:** Customer cancels an order prior to shipment (100% refund initiated instantly).
- **Approved Return:** Customer returns an eligible item within the 7 calendar days return window, and the item passes warehouse quality inspection.
- **Failed Delivery / Return to Origin (RTO):** Package cannot be delivered after 3 attempts or customer refuses delivery at doorstep.
- **Stockout / Seller Cancellation:** Merchant or fulfillment center cannot fulfill confirmed order due to unexpected inventory discrepancy.
- **Duplicate or Erroneous Debit:** Multiple charges incurred due to checkout gateway latency.

2. Authoritative Refund Processing Timelines

Refunds are credited back strictly to the original source payment instrument, with the exception of Cash on Delivery (COD) orders which are settled via customer-provided bank account details (NEFT/UPI):

Original Payment Method	ShopEase Initiation SLA	Banking Crediting SLA	Total Expected SLA
UPI (GPay / PhonePe / Paytm)	Instant to 4 hours	24 to 48 hours	24-48 hours
Digital Wallets	Instant to 4 hours	12 to 24 hours	24 hours
Debit Cards	Within 24 hours	4 to 6 business days	5-7 business days
Credit Cards	Within 24 hours	4 to 6 business days	5-7 business days
Net Banking	Within 24 hours	2 to 4 business days	3-5 business days
Cash on Delivery (NEFT / UPI)	Within 24 hours of bank details	2 to 4 business days	3-5 business days

3. Cash on Delivery (COD) Refund Settlement Process

Because cash cannot be physically returned to the doorstep post-delivery, refunds for returned COD purchases are executed digitally:

1. When a return is approved, an encrypted SMS and email link is dispatched inviting the customer to provide verified refund payout coordinates.
2. The customer may enter either their verified UPI ID (VPA) or Bank Account Details (Account Number + IFSC Code + Beneficiary Name).
3. Our payout system performs an instant penny-drop verification (₹1 deposit) to confirm account holder authenticity.

4. Upon successful warehouse inspection, the full refund is remitted via IMPS/NEFT within 3 to 5 business days.

4. Partial Refunds, Shipping Adjustments & Non-Refundable Cases

Partial Order Returns: When a customer returns one product from a multi-item order, the refund corresponds precisely to the net item value paid for that specific item. Pro-rated promotional discounts applied across the basket are deducted accordingly.

Shipping Fee Refunds: If an entire order is cancelled before shipping, or if an order is returned due to a defective/damaged item, the full shipping fee is refunded. If an order is returned due to customer remorse or size misfit, standard shipping charges incurred on delivery are non-refundable.

Non-Refundable Scenarios: Refunds will be declined if items are returned outside the 7 calendar days return window, if products exhibit user-induced physical damage or tampering, if original manufacturer serial numbers do not match order records, or if consumable hygiene seals have been broken.

ESCALATION FOR DELAYED REFUNDS

If a refund is not credited within the stated banking SLA, customers should check with their bank using the Unique Transaction Reference (UTR) code provided in the ShopEase refund confirmation SMS. If the bank cannot locate the credit, contact refunds@shopease.example for priority reconciliation.

End of Document
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Version 1.0